that March, Ayub told Ambassador at Large Averell Harriman that Pakistan was normalizing relations with China and the Soviet Union, and would settle with Beijing to protect its own interests. He denied that this was an effort to "embarrass India," but Harriman questioned how any such agreement—de jure or de facto—could not trouble India.[204] And it did upset Indian officials, who had been worried about a potential Sino-Pakistan entente.[205]

Both India and the US saw Pakistan's relationship with China as a problem. The US intelligence community doubted that Pakistan would jettison its US ties because Beijing and Moscow could not help Rawalpindi beyond a point.[206] There was concern, however, that Pakistan's relationship with China could create trouble for American and Indian interests. Kennedy cited Pakistan's announcement that it would no longer oppose communist Chinese representation at the UN.[207] Moreover, as Nehru told Kennedy, Pakistan's flirtation with China made Kashmir harder to solve because of Indian public opinion.[208] India and the US became even more upset when China and Pakistan made public their border negotiations in May 1962, adding to the pressure on India.[209]

Kennedy was fed up. He nixed the Pakistani suggestion of US-Pakistan joint defense planning vis-à-vis India. He remained hesitant to restate guarantees to Pakistan in the event of an Indian attack, noting that he was "extremely reluctant to give any new commitments." He also questioned why the previous commitments were ever made.[210]

The administration also refused to rule out supplying India militarily, as Pakistan wanted. In late 1959 and spring 1960, Ayub had acknowledged that India faced a "real danger" from China and thought it "natural" for India to increase its defense expenditures. At that time, however, he had been using the China threat to elicit more US military aid.[211] In 1961, Ayub had argued that India was a lost cause against China because of its vulnerabilities—Pakistan was the true firewall in the subcontinent. In a contradictory argument, however, he had also said that the US should not aid Indians because they were "very trigger-happy people." Kennedy had told him that if India asked for military aid in the event of an "impending war with China," the US would consider it, but first talk with Pakistan. In early 1962, Pakistani officials had indicated they would not object to aid to India to fight China, but Delhi was more likely to appease Beijing.[212]